



Parks Department Meeting June 17th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FwI6_RWUNO8
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Muny Parks and Recreation Board Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: Tuesday, June 17, 2025

Location: City Hall

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The Muny Parks and Recreation Board meeting was called to order on Tuesday, June 17, 2025, at City Hall by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Sandra Parks, James, Mark, Powers, Bush, President Marshall, and Shannon.
 - **Members Absent:** (None explicitly noted in roll call)
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Marshall (with initial proceedings facilitated by Shannon).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.

- **Approval of Minutes:** Minutes from the previous meeting were reviewed and approved by voice vote.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

(Note: No formal ordinances, resolutions, or contracts requiring roll call votes were presented during this session. Business consisted of departmental reports and operational updates.)

- **00:02:15 Superintendent Report (Parks & Facilities Overview)**
 - **Presenter:** Mr. Carlo, Superintendent
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - **Mowing & Maintenance:** Crews are caught up on mowing and weed-eating following weather delays and mower repairs. A dedicated four-person weed-eating team is assisting with park beautification.
 - **Playground Repairs:** Minor equipment repairs are underway. Westside Park and Heeken Park playground equipment issues are being addressed with contractors (Midwest Meadows) or taped off with caution tape and orange fencing for safety.
 - **Westside Park:** The skate park kickoff/ribbon cutting occurred over the weekend with strong attendance from residents, board members, the mayor's office, and city council members. Cosmetic work and safety signage are pending. Major sewer line work and restrooms are completed and open. Diamond renovations are starting, including electrical/scoreboard updates and field turning. The basketball court has drainage/water retention issues that will be evaluated by the city engineer and sanitation experts.
 - **Riverview Park:** Sanitation line repairs are complete; awaiting installation of new restrooms (bidded out). The baseball/kickball field is prepped and ready. Park lighting timers were adjusted following neighborhood safety/noise complaints. Swing sets are awaiting replacement parts. Graffiti on a park building was cleaned up by summer interns.
 - **Thomas Park:** Restrooms are bundled with Riverview's project for upcoming installation. The splash pad is operational with a new push-button setup (moving to a standard 6-prong model across parks). Minor parent-child discussions occurred regarding safe playground usage. The basketball court is outdated and needs a full overhaul or consideration in the 5-year plan. The baseball diamond is seeing renewed interest from the Brawl Center.
 - **Tuilli Pool:** Opened with Memorial Day challenges but is fully operational. Recent security concerns, police calls, and firecracker incidents (including items thrown from the Tuilli tower) have prompted safety discussions with the mayor's office, Chief Sloan, and the YMCA. Operational changes include revised hours (12:00 PM to 4:00 PM), age groups, and capacity caps

(300-400 people max). Backpack restrictions are being enforced to prevent contraband.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; accepted without formal vote.
- **00:21:14 Programming and Events Report**
 - **Presenter:** Mr. Carlo (wearing his programming “hat”)
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - **Summer Intern Program:** Launched at North Side Middle School with approximately 110 youth participants for a 6-week program. Whitley Neighborhood Association is serving as the fiscal sponsor. The program was featured on Fox 59. MITS and park vans are providing transportation. Youth are placed in diverse work locations (parks, office settings, gardening/farming, schools, and the YMCA).
 - **Learn to Swim Program:** A partnership between Muny Parks, Ball State University research grants, and Cardinal Swim Club featuring 116 participants (children, teens, and adults up to age 70) across 8 weeks and 16 lessons.
 - **Sports Clinics & Tournaments:** Free baseball/softball clinics led by Randy O’Connor Barn Academy start June 23 at Cambridge field. Free youth basketball leagues and a back-to-school tournament are planned for July and August. Aqua Zumba runs Monday and Wednesday nights at Tuilli Pool, and “Dive-In Movies” are planned to return at the end of the summer.
 - **Community Events & Partnerships:** Flag football (Third and 11) is active on Wednesdays at the ball field. Upcoming events include kickball, adult flag football, a backpack giveaway on July 22 at McCullough Park (sponsored by Walmart South), Trunk or Treat on October 18 at Heeken Park, and a winter coat giveaway on November 4 at McCullough Park.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; accepted without formal vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No open public comment period or general citizen floor speakers were recorded during this portion of the transcript; all inquiries and discussions were conducted among board members and staff.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Follow-up meetings regarding Tuilli Pool safety protocols and community hours are scheduled for the following day with the mayor’s office, police chief, and YMCA director.

- **Adjournment:** The meeting concluded following the completion of the superintendent and programming reports (exact adjournment time not explicitly stated in the transcript).

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